

Andrew Hinson - Platform Engineer

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Profile

Platform Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing durable, distributed systems across Kafka-based event streaming, Kubernetes-native infrastructure, and AWS cloud environments. Proven track record delivering high-throughput data pipelines, self-service platform tooling, and CI/CD automation for multi-tenant production systems. Works primarily in Go, Python, and Java, with a systems engineering mindset focused on reliability, observability, and self-service developer tooling.

Work Experience

01/2026 — present
BATON ROUGE, LA

Data Engineer, Data Platform LOUISIANA BLUE

- Implemented Unity Catalog across 200+ data tables to enforce granular row- and column-level access controls, delivering database schema governance supporting HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Architected and optimized automated ETL pipelines with PySpark and Databricks Workflows, leveraging cluster auto-scaling and Photon acceleration to reduce compute costs by 25% annually.

01/2023 — 08/2025
REMOTE

Data Engineer, Data Platform FETCH REWARDS

- Built and maintained FSD, the internal PaaS every service at Fetch shipped on: a Go GitOps engine where developers declared infrastructure in one YAML, and FSD provisioned any AWS service in use at Fetch and deployed to ECS or EKS.
- Owned the Kafka Connect path in FSD, running connectors on Strimzi on EKS so teams could connect Kafka to data sources without a platform ticket, and scaled them to handle millions of concurrent users during the 2025 Super Bowl ad campaign.
- Owned the Slack and Airflow integrations for an n8n LLM workflow that turned dbt, Airflow, and Snowflake run data into concise pipeline failure summaries for on-call.
- Managed telemetry pipeline reliability and mapped data lineage into DataHub using Kubernetes, Helm, and AWS cloud environments enabling teams to cut spend by easily identifying unused assets.
- Owned Kafka pipeline on-call, building Grafana alerting wired to PagerDuty for platform and analytics teams.
- Reduced S3 and cloud infrastructure costs by \$70k/month by building internal automation tools for storage lifecycle management.
- Built Flink-on-Kafka pipelines tracking real-time user interactions and signups, delivering minute-level KPIs to senior stakeholders via InfluxDB and Grafana.
- Built a Snowflake access-control pipeline that centralized permissions and enforced data governance for high-scale environments.

03/2022 — 12/2022
REMOTE

Data Engineer, Social Media Feed FETCH REWARDS

- Built a social-feed backend pipeline serving 12M+ monthly users using Go, AWS Lambda, ECS, SNS, SQS, and Snowflake — a microservices and serverless architecture operating at production scale.
- Developed a Go service to stress-test high-throughput streaming topics, identifying backpressure and failure modes that reduced compute provisioning costs by \$5k/month.

06/2021 — 03/2022
REMOTE

Tableau Server Admin FETCH REWARD

- Owned 800+ user Tableau operations. Scaled BI infrastructure on AWS EC2 from single to multi-node clusters, reducing extract times by 75%.

01/2012 — 01/2018
New Iberia, United States

Infantry Team Leader Army National Guard

- Led security operations in disaster zones, building the frameworks that kept personnel safe.
- Ran adversary-simulation exercises overseas and trained multinational partner forces.

Projects

Stream Join Lab

- Built a local CDC lakehouse pipeline: Postgres → Debezium → Kafka → Flink DataStream joins → Iceberg, queried via Trino and Superset.
- Implemented Flink keyed co-process joins (player lookup, match assembly, rank-as-of) with join-quality metrics.
- Instrumented the full stack with Grafana and Prometheus, including alert runbooks.

Technical Skills

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Go	Python	Java	TypeScript
SQL			

CLOUD & ORCHESTRATION

AWS (ECS, EKS, Lambda, S3, SQS, SNS, EC2, IAM)	Kubernetes	Terraform	Helm
Docker			

DATA & DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

Kafka	Kafka Connect	Strimzi	Apache Flink
Snowflake	Trino	Apache Iceberg	Debezium
Apache Spark	Databricks	InfluxDB	Apache Airflow
dbt			

OBSERVABILITY & TELEMETRY

Prometheus	Grafana	Loki	CloudWatch
DataHub	PagerDuty	OpenTelemetry	

CI/CD

GitHub Actions	Bitbucket Pipelines	Jenkins	Argo CD
n8n			

OPERATING SYSTEMS

Red Hat (RHEL)	Arch	Amazon Linux	
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Volunteering

12/2009 — 12/2011
Plaquemine, United States

Habitat for Humanity

- Contributed hands-on labor to build community housing, following precise technical plans and collaborating with team members to meet project deadlines.

Social Links

LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/william-a-hinson	GitHub: https://github.com/Andrew-Hinson
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